Folder Profiler

How to run it · Windows 10 / 11 (64-bit) · about 5 minutes of your time (more for very large folders)

What this does. It counts and measures the files in a folder: file types, sizes, dates and a short format tag of each file. It **never copies, uploads or saves your files**. By default (level 0) it records no folder names, and the only file names are those of **assembly files** (.sldasm, .asm, .iam, .catproduct), which are needed to group parts under their assembly — you can hide them, or record more by choosing level 1 or 2 (below). It does not use the internet. At the end it gives you **one small zip file** to send to us. How much it records is your choice (below).

How much should it record? (your choice)

Level	What is recorded
0 (default)	File types, sizes, dates, short format tags and anonymous folder ids. No folder names. Only assembly file names (can be hidden).
1	Level 0 plus the **names and paths** of files and folders. No file contents.
2	Level 1 plus the **names of files that assemblies, drawings and STEP files refer to**, so parts can be grouped under their real assembly. Nothing else is read out of your files.

Levels 1 and 2 reveal file and folder names. Pick them only if you are comfortable sharing those. If your chosen folder contains big "container" folders, set *Projects are 2 levels below* so the real projects inside are listed separately. Both settings are on the page that `run-ui.bat` opens (or `--level 2 --project-depth 2` on the command line).

Archives: .zip and .tar.gz files are opened to see the CAD files inside (read in memory, nothing is extracted to your disk); .7z and .rar are only listed. Untick *"Look inside archives"* on the page, or use `--archives off`, to skip them. A file inside an archive that is identical to one already in the same project is not counted twice.

If it stops, and what to send us

If the run stops	Crash, power cut, restart, Ctrl+C — start it again with the **same settings and folder**. It continues from the last saved point, not from the beginning (progress is kept in a hidden `.resume` folder inside `output` and removed when the run finishes). Tick *"Start from scratch"* to ignore it.
Run statistics	Every run also makes `run_stats_….zip` (and a *"Download run statistics"* button): how long each step took, and your computer's CPU, memory and reading speed every 5 seconds. No file names, folder names, computer name or user name. Send it along if we ask how your machine performed.
Nothing is hashed	The tool never computes fingerprints of your files and never reads a file in full (except, at level 2, the assembly, drawing and STEP files whose references are listed). Folders are read at any depth.

Pick one way to run it

Option A — Docker (most locked-down)	Option B — no Docker
Needs **Docker Desktop** installed and running. The tool runs in a sealed box: your folder is mounted **read-only** and the box has **no internet**. First run needs internet once, to prepare the box (about 1 minute).	Nothing to install: Python is included in the package. The tool runs on your PC the normal way. It still never uses the internet and only reads your files.

Steps (both options)

1. **Unzip the package.** Right-click `folder-profiler.zip` → **Extract All…** → Extract, into a short location such as `C:\Profiler`. *Do not run it from inside the zip window* — it must be extracted first.
2. **Start it.** In the extracted folder:
   - **Option A:** drag the folder you want measured onto `run-docker.bat`.
   - **Option B:** drag the folder you want measured onto `run.bat`.

   (Or double-click the file, then drag your folder into the black window and press **Enter**.)
3. **If Windows shows a blue "Windows protected your PC" screen:** click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. This appears because the file is not code-signed; it is plain text you can open in Notepad. **Option A only:** if it says Docker is not running, start Docker Desktop, wait until it shows "running", and try again.
4. **Wait.** A black window shows progress lines such as *"chunk 3 saved (5,000 files)"* (a page-based run shows a progress bar). Large folders can take a long time because every file has to be opened to read its type — leave the window open until it says **Done**.
5. **Send us the zip.** The result is `profile_<folder>_<date>.zip` in the `output` folder next to the launcher (Windows opens it for you). Email or upload that one file.

Check it before you send (optional)

- Open the zip. Inside are `Files.csv`, `Dirs.csv`, `Projects.csv`, `Extensions.csv`, `Run_info.csv` and a short note. Open any of them in Excel or Notepad.
- You will see extensions, sizes, dates and codes only — no folder names, no paths, no file text. The one exception is the `asm_name` column in `Files.csv`, which holds assembly file names (or codes if you hide them).
- **To hide assembly file names:** in the browser page (`run-ui.bat`) tick *"Hide assembly file names"*. They then appear as codes like `ASM-3F9A1C2B.SLDASM`.
- The only names included are the name of the folder you chose and the names of the folders directly inside it (the "project" names). Nothing deeper.

What is in each file

File	Contents

Files.csv	One row per file: project, number, extension, size, modified date, depth, format tag (e.g. STEP, PDF), anonymous folder id, the assembly file name (assembly files only), and *archive* (zip, tar, 7z or rar for files found inside an archive)
Dirs.csv	The folder tree as anonymous ids only (random each run; cannot be turned back into folder names)
Projects.csv	One row per project folder: file count, total size, date range
Extensions.csv	File count and size for each extension, per project
Run_info.csv	Tool version, date, Windows version, how it was run (Docker or not), folder name, totals, any unreadable files, and how long each step took

If something goes wrong

You see	Do this
“Python was not found” (Option B)	You are missing the `python` folder. Extract the *whole* zip again (Extract All) and run `run.bat` from the extracted folder.
“Docker Desktop was not found” (Option A)	Install Docker Desktop, or use Option B instead.
“Not a folder”	Drag the folder again, or paste its full path and press Enter.
“Something went wrong”	Send us `output\error_log.txt`. Your name and folder paths are removed from it automatically.
Antivirus blocks `run.bat` or the `python` folder	Allow it, or tell us — the Python inside is the official Windows build from python.org.

Everything the tool does is in `file_profiler.py` (plain text, open in Notepad). Questions: reply to the person who sent you this package.